



CATEGORY	DVD-ROM DRIVES						
	ASUS DVD-E616	Benq DVP-1648A	LG DRD-8160B	LITEON LTD-165H	Pioneer DVD-106S/2	Samsung SD-616	Sony DDU1621
Features							
Drive Specifications							
Speed (DVD-ROM \CD-ROM)	16X\48X	16X\48X	16X\48X	16X\48X	16X\40X	16X\48X	16X\40X
Disk loading mechanism	Tray	Tray	Tray	Tray	Slot-In	Tray	Tray
Interface (IDE/SCSI)	IDE	IDE	IDE	IDE	IDE	IDE	IDE
Data Buffer Size (KB)	512	512	512	512	256	512	512
Front Panel Controls/indicators	Play/Fwd, Eject/Stop, Volume, HeadPhone Jack, Disk Indicator	Stop/Eject, Volume, HeadPhone Jack, Disk Indicator	Stop/Eject, Volume, HeadPhone Jack, Disk Indicator	Play/Fwd, Eject/Stop, Volume, HeadPhone Jack, Disk Indicator	Stop/Eject, Volume, HeadPhone Jack, Disk Indicator	Stop/Eject, Volume, HeadPhone Jack, Disk Indicator	Stop/Eject, Volume, HeadPhone Jack, Disk Indicator
Package contents							
Audio Cable	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓	✓
IDE Cable	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓	✓
Software Provided	AsusDVD 3.0	WinDVD 3.1 and DOS driver v2.14	PowerDVD 4.0	PowerDVD 4.0	None	PowerDVD 4.0	PowerDVD 2.55
Manuals and Documentation	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Performance							
DVD Test (sec)***							
Assorted Read Speed	146.46	162.42	201.21	144.14	161.23	147.76	168.49
Disk registration test	12.08	8.89	7.6	12.76	9.76	15.13	11.71
VOB File extraction test - Flask MPEG	78	74.61	76.83	84.76	75.72	74.38	78.6
Nero DVDSPeed v0.53							
Seek time (ms)***	169	75	105	67	77	89	458
CPU Utilization (%)***	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Spin down time (sec)***	7.77	1.95	2.49	2.31	3.04	3.74	3.14
Average speed (X)	7.04	7.22	3.73	7.46	7.27	7.38	3.71
SiSoft Sandra 2002 Professional							
Sequential read (KBps)	6144	9216	4096	9216	9216	8192	5120
Random Read (KBps)	625	1100	755	720	1119	1035	513
Average Access Time (ms)***	91	51	71	82	50	54	111
Exact Audio Copy (sec)***							
Track 1	15.83	17.51	26.51	14.98	22.05	26.16	20.27
Track 2	13.07	13.05	31.74	11.86	25.07	32.71	15.68
Track 3	7.78	8.64	23.98	7.07	19.76	24.81	8.17
Warranty & Support							
Replacement warranty	**	**	*	*	**	*	*
Period of warranty (Years)	1	1	1	1	1	15 months	1
Overall Score							
Features (10%)	17	15	15	17	9	18	17
Performance (50%)	35.79	42.66	32.49	39.47	38.77	36.38	31.73
Warranty & Support (20%)	5	5	7	3	3	5	4
Value for Money (20%)	6.32	15.4	13.57	17.05	10.19	10.88	8.66
Overall Product Rating	64.11	78.06	68.06	76.52	60.96	70.26	61.39
Overall Grade	B-	A+	B	A	C+	B+	C+
Vendors Name	Neoteric Infomatique	BenQ	LG Electronics	Media Tech	Mnemonic System	Samsung Electronics (SEIT)	Rashi Peripherals
Phone	022-4172600	022-5705230	0120-4560900	022-2396696	022-8010871	011-6322517	022-8260258
E-mail	sales@neoteric-info.com	pankajpamani@benq.com	response@ezbuy.com	sales@mediatechindia.com	mnemonic@vsnl.com	marketing@samsungindia.com	ho@rptechindia.com
Webpage	www.asus.com	www.benq.com	www.lgindia.com	www.liteonit.com	www.pioneer.com	www.samsungindia.com	www.rptechindia.com
Price (Rs)	6,680	2,995	2,800	2,650	3,750	4,000	4,500

Disclaimer: * The drives are replaced within warranty period ** Repair is carried out during warranty period ***Lower the better

458 ms to seek out the necessary data.

We also logged each drive's CPU utilisation to get a handle on the amount of CPU resources hogged by a drive under usage. All seven drives did well here, utilising not more than 1 per cent of the CPU power, utilising DMA (Direct Memory Access) to the full.

Many new drives save power by spinning down when the drive is not in use. This is essentially a power-saving feature and is designed to lighten the load your computer's power supply has to carry. The drive with the fastest spin-down time was the Benq DVP-1648A, logging 1.95 seconds. A close second was the

LITEON LTD-165H, which took 2.31 seconds. The ASUS DVD-E616 disappointed us and took 7.77 seconds.

A 498 MB VOB file was used for calculating the average speed of the drive. This score holds import because one would buy a new DVD-ROM drive or upgrade from an older 8x drive to get better performance. If a drive can't live up to its rated speed, it doesn't make sense investing in it.

The winner in this category was the ASUS DVD-E616 with an average speed of 7.04x, while the Sony DDU1621-CO and the LG DRD 8160B with an average speed of 3.71x and 3.73x, respectively, performed under par.